

Basic account management

Since FreeBSD lets multiple users access the computer at the same time, the existence of an account management protocol to streamline various individual operations is of prime importance to the scope of the FreeBSD environment. Though at any given point in time, only one user can access the computer and the keyboard, multiple users can log into the system via the network. However, each of them needs to have their personal user account to access and use the system.

At the outset, there are three kinds of accounts native to the FreeBSD Operating system:

1. System Accounts: These accounts are used to run and execute the services of mail, DNS, and web servers. More than anything, these help maintain system security. Otherwise, should all services run as the superuser, the risk of them acting without restriction would loom large at all times.



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FreeBSD lets multiple users access the system simultaneously

2. User Accounts: These accounts are allocated to real people, which they subsequently use to access and log into the system. Every individual logging into the system must have a unique user account. Subsequently, this lets the administrator determine the actions of each user logged into the system. Additionally, it also keeps a particular set of users from interfering and tampering with the settings of the rest. Every user is given the liberty of setting up an environment to best suit their system usage by making the necessary configurations to their default shell, key bindings, editor, and language settings.

To begin with, each user account on a FreeBSD system comes associated with specific information. They are:

- User Name
- Password
- User ID (UID)
- Group ID (GID)